"How about up there?" Rani suggested.

Divya and Rani looked up at the sky. The sun glared back at them. Everything was white-hot and dusty.

"No," they agreed together. "No water there."

Divya collapsed into the boat with Rani and gnawed on a lotus stem. She got tired.

"Do you know why Manju's parents left the village," Divya asked. "They went to the city where they have water. Maybe we should all go." said Divya.

"You go," Rani snapped. "No one asked you to be here."

"Fine," Divya said. And she stomped back home. But it wasn't fine! There was still no water, still no rain.

The next day, Divya brushed her teeth with muddy tank water in a tiny glass.

"Thooo!" she spat.

In school, the class was half-empty. More families had left the area. She was missing all her friends! In the middle of Environmental Studies class, she turned and ran out of school.



She ran and ran until she was panting. She finally sat at the side of the road.

"I have to find the water!" she huffed.

"Can I help?" said a voice. It was Rani who had seen Divya running away from school.

Divya beamed. "Yes!"

"We have to do this properly," Rani said, "Like real Sanitary Engineers."

"Like who…?" Divya asked.

"Sanitary Engineers build pipes and tanks and drains. I am going to be one when I grow up," Rani said.

Divya and Rani decided to draw a map of their village and all its tanks and streams, showing all the places where the water might have flowed.

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